



Lying in wait

A 1960s Viet Cong poster boasts that US patrols, however well-armed, stand little chance of surviving ambush in the dense jungle. The propagandists targeted US ground forces in particular, hoping to lower morale.

Safe havens

Viet Cong warfare was unlike anything their opponents had experienced. It was a war with no frontline in the accepted sense. The terrain also favored the insurgents and their tactics. South Vietnam's rainforests, mountains, and swamplands provided them with well-concealed staging areas from which to launch hit-and-run attacks. Following the example set by Chinese communists in guerrilla campaigns against Japan, these sanctuaries also served as training grounds and headquarters.